prevent any future such attacks in cooperation with the United Nations, Interpol, and other intelligence agencies. Equally urgent, moreover, is the need to resolve the sixty-three-year-old Indo-Pakistani conflict over Kashmir, which has to date cost over 100,000 lives, mostly those of young Kashmiris, and countless billions of dollars in wasted resources, triggering three wars and almost igniting two nuclear confrontations in the past ten years that could have mushroomed to claim hundreds of millions of South Asian lives.

Some of the world's best minds have sought workable solutions to this complex problem, and many proposals and plans have been made to expedite the draft of a road map to peace on which India and Pakistan could finally agree. My guru of Indian civilization and Sanskrit, Dr. W. Norman Brown, founding chair of the Department of South Asian Regional Studies at the University of Pennsylvania, awakened my own awareness of this "most troublesome Kashmir conflict," as he called it, during my first year in his department, fifty-six years ago. Forty years later, my friend Professor John Kenneth Galbraith, President John F. Kennedy's ambassador to India, regretfully confessed that he'd "had no luck" in trying his best to persuade Prime Minister Nehru to agree to a UN–sponsored plebiscite for Kashmir. I had just begun to write my biography *Nehru: A Tryst with Destiny*, and I visited Galbraith before flying on to New Delhi, where I met with Nehru's sister "Nan," Madame Vijaya Lakshmi Pandit, and her daughter Rita Dhar, before flying into Kashmir.

Seeing how pervasively stifling a force India maintained in Srinagar, however, and how oppressive its presence was to so many of Kashmir's brightest young men and women, I then favored the UN Security Council's call for a plebiscite as perhaps the best and fairest self-determination solution. That remains Pakistan's preferred solution, but since 1954, it has been completely rejected by India. In light of the recently failed insurgency in Kashmir, and Pakistan's nearly failed national status, it is no longer a viable option.

What, then, must be done to end this most prolonged, incredibly frustrating South Asian conflict before it explodes once again, endangering all the world with its toxic fallout? Before considering a potential solution to this problem, we must analyze its roots.